

NANDI ZHANG

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EDUCATION

University of Rochester
PhD in Computer Science
Advisor: Professor Yukang Yan

Sept. 2025 -

University of Calgary
MSc in Computer Science (Thesis-based)
Advisor: Professor Ryo Suzuki

Sept. 2023 - Aug. 2025

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology
BSc in Data Science and Technology
Advisor: Professor Xiaojuan Ma

Sept. 2018 - Aug. 2022

RESEARCH INTEREST

My research explores how humans perceive, interpret, and act mainly within **Mixed Reality**, **Human-AI Interaction**, and **Human-Robot Interaction** contexts. I build computational models that both explain and shape human perception and behavior, and I seek to advance techniques in large language models (LLMs) and computer vision to design and enable novel interactions in Mixed Reality.

PUBLICATION

- [1] **Nandi Zhang**, Tongshuang Wu, Yukang Yan. Through Word-Tinted Glasses: Exploring How In-Situ AR Descriptions Shape Memory for Physical Objects. (Submitted to **CHI'27**)
- [2] Helena Qing Huang, **Nandi Zhang**, Yukang Yan. Unwrapped: Supporting Reflective Exploration of Music Listening Data through HumanAI Collaboration. (Submitted to **CHI'27**)
- [3] Yu Jiang, Chun-Hao Yang, Xinning He, Xuning Hu, **Nandi Zhang**, Jrgen Steimle, and Yukang Yan. DiminishedSelf: Controlling, Embodying, and Becoming the Virtual Environment. (Submitted to **CHI'27**)
- [4] **Nandi Zhang** and Yukang Yan. Remapping Time in Augmented Reality. (**UIST'26**)
- [5] Kewen Peng, **Nandi Zhang**. Harmonia: Physiological Signal-Driven Music for Remote Relationship Maintenance. (**UIST'26 EA**)
- [6] **Nandi Zhang**, Yukang Yan, and Ryo Suzuki. From Following to Understanding: Investigating the Role of Reflective Prompts in AR-Guided Tasks to Promote Task Understanding. (**CHI'25**)
- [7] Hanfang Lyu, Xiaoyu Wang, **Nandi Zhang**, Shuai Ma, Qian Zhu, Yuhan Luo, Fu-Gee Tsung, and Xiaojuan Ma. Signaling Human Intentions to Service Robots: Understanding the Use of Social Cues during In-Person Conversations. (**CHI'25**)
Honorable Mention
- [8] Aditya Gunturu, Shivesh Singh Jadon, **Nandi Zhang**, Morteza Faraji, Jarin Thundathil, Tafreed Ahmad, Wesley Willett, and Ryo Suzuki. RealitySummary: Exploring On-Demand Mixed Reality Text Summarization and Question Answering using Large Language Models. (**SUI'25**)
- [9] **Nandi Zhang**, Nelson Wong. A Pedagogical Model for Soft-Skill Education in Computer Science: Pass/Fail Grading with Public In-Class Feedback. (**WCCCE'25**)

- [10] Aditya Gunturu, Yi Wen, **Nandi Zhang**, Jarin Thundathil, Rubaiat Habib Kazi, and Ryo Suzuki. Augmented Physics: A Machine Learning-Powered Tool for Creating Interactive Physics Simulations from Static Diagrams. *In Proceedings of the Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology*. 2024. (**UIST'24**)
Best Paper Award
- [11] Peixuan Xiong, Yukai Zhang, **Nandi Zhang**, Shihan Fu, Xin Li, Yadan Zheng, Jinni Zhou, Xiquan Hu, and Mingming Fan. To Reach the Unreachable: Exploring the Potential of VR Hand Redirection for Upper Limb Rehabilitation. *In Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 2024. (**CHI'24**)

WORKING EXPERIENCE

SenseTime Group Inc.

Jan 2021 - Jan 2022

Research Intern

Contributed to diverse machine learning projects, addressing neural collapse in transfer learning and developing a comprehensive vision model training framework. Explored few-shot distillation techniques and implemented language models, including BERT and GPT-2. Pre-trained large-scale visio-linguistic models and worked on reinforcement learning systems like AlphaZero.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

CSC 442: Artificial Intelligence

Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Daniel Gildea

Department of Computer Science, University of Rochester

CSC 242: Artificial Intelligence

Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Adam Purtee

Department of Computer Science, University of Rochester

DATA 201: Thinking with Data

Winter 2024 & Fall 2024

Head Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Nelson Wong

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

SCIE 398: Communication for Computer Science

Fall 2024

Course Development Assistant

Instructor: Professor Nelson Wong

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

CPSC 233: Introduction to CS for CS Majors II

Fall 2024

Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Jonathan Hudson

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

DATA 201: Thinking with Data

Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant

Instructor: Professor Nelson Wong

Department of Computer Science, University of Calgary

SERVICE

Paper Review

UIST 2026

CHI 2026

CHI Play 2026

CHI 2025

CSCW 2025

ISMAR 2025

Student Volunteer

CHI 2024

SKILLS

Programming Languages and Frameworks: Python (Proficient), C# (Proficient), Pytorch (Proficient), C++ (Proficient), Swift (Proficient), R (Familiar), Java (Familiar), JavaScript (Familiar), SQL and NoSQL (Familiar)

Web Technologies: React (Proficient)

Software and Tools: Unity (Proficient), Tableau (Proficient), Qualtrics (Proficient), OpenRefine (Proficient), Matlab (Familiar)

Languages: English (Fluent), Mandarin (Native)